

Review Replies Business: 2-Week Launch Plan

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The offer

You sell one thing: "I make your Google profile look busy and cared for, so more people who find you actually call." You never sell "AI." The AI is how you deliver 20 clients in a few hours a week. It's not what they're buying.

Goal for these two weeks: 2 paying clients, or 1 paying plus 2 free pilots that convert in week 3.

Tier	Price	What's included
Pilot	Free for 30 days	Full Growth tier, in exchange for a testimonial and before/after screenshots. Max 2 of these.
Starter	£129/month	Reply to every new review within 48 hours, clean up profile info, monthly 1-page report
Growth	£199/month	Starter + 1 Google post per week with a photo, Q&A section filled in, review request link and QR card for their counter
Catch-up fee	£79 one-time	Replying to the backlog of old unanswered reviews (often 30 to 100 of them)

No contracts. Month to month. Contractors and restaurant owners have been burned by agencies locking them into 12 months, and "cancel anytime" removes their biggest objection on the spot.

One rule: you never write fake reviews or buy them. Google suspends profiles for it, and in the UK fake reviews have been illegal under the Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act since April 2025, with the CMA able to fine businesses for them. Your job is replying to real reviews and helping the business get more real ones.

Tools and setup (days 1 and 2)

Total startup cost is under £50. Don't buy expensive review software before you have a client. You can run the first 5 clients by hand from a spreadsheet, and the software can come later once the money's in.

Tool	Cost	What it's for
Claude or ChatGPT	£0 to £20/month	Writing review replies, posts and audit reports
Business Gmail (yourname.reviews@gmail.com) or Google Workspace	£0 to £7/month	Looks professional, keeps client access separate
Google Sheets	Free	Your prospect list and client tracker
Canva	Free	The audit PDF, weekly post graphics, QR review cards
Simple one-page site (Carrd)	About £15/year	Somewhere to send people. Optional for week 1.
Business cards	About £20	For walk-ins. Your name, phone, one line: "I get local businesses more Google reviews and calls."

How you get access to a client's profile: they open their Google Business Profile, go to Business Profile settings, then Managers, then "Add," and add your Gmail as a Manager (not Owner). They keep ownership. You can reply to reviews, edit info and post. Walk them through it on the phone; it takes 3 minutes.

Pick a business name that says what it does. "Leicester Review Care" beats something clever. Set up a Google Sheet with two tabs: Prospects (columns: business, niche, phone, rating, review count, unanswered reviews, last post date, status, notes) and Clients (business, start date, tier, price, reviews replied this month, posts this month).

Register as a sole trader with HMRC once you start earning. It's free and takes 15 minutes online. Your first £1,000 a year of self-employed income is covered by the trading allowance, and you have until 5 October after the end of the tax year to register. Keep every invoice and receipt in a folder from day one.

Finding clients in your area

Leicester is a great city for this. It's packed with family-run independents (the Golden Mile, Narborough Road, Queens Road, Evington Road) and owners who are in the shop every day, which makes walk-ins easy. Build 50 prospects in about 2 hours using the steps below, then start with the starter list at the end of this section.

Best niches to start with, in order:

Niche	Why they buy	Typical review count
Private dentists and orthodontists	One private patient is worth £1,000+ over a few years, and they obsess over their rating	80 to 400
Roofers, heating engineers, plumbers	Big tickets, owners are on job sites and never touch Google	20 to 150
Auto repair and body shops	Customers check reviews more than anything else before choosing	50 to 300
Independent restaurants and cafes	High review volume, owner has no time to reply	100 to 1,000
Salons, barbers, med spas	Very review-driven, active owners, quick to decide	50 to 300

Skip national chains and franchises like mydentist, Bupa Dental, Kwik Fit or Costa (head office controls their profile) and skip anyone with under 15 reviews (not enough to work with yet).

How to build the list:

1. Open Google Maps and search "private dentist Leicester," then "roofer Wigston," "barber Narborough Road," and so on.
2. Click each result. Scroll their reviews and sort by Newest.
3. Count how many of the last 10 reviews have no "Response from the owner." 5 or more unanswered = a great prospect.
4. Check the "Updates" or posts section. Nothing in 3+ months = another gap you can point at.
5. Note anything broken: missing hours, no photos in the last year, wrong website link, no services listed.
6. Log it in your Prospects sheet. Aim for 50 rows. Ten per niche is a good spread.

The sweet spot is a business rated 4.0 to 4.6 with 40 to 300 reviews and lots of silence from the owner. They're good enough to be busy and neglected enough to need you. A 3.2-star business has bigger problems than you can fix, and a 4.9 with every review answered doesn't need you.

Leicester starter list

These are real independent businesses I found online on 5 October 2026. I couldn't check their Google reviews from here, so open each one on Google Maps first and only pitch the ones with a pile of unanswered reviews. Treat this as your first 20 minutes of list building, then add 30 more yourself.

Business	Type	Area	Source
L&A Roofing Contractors	Roofer, since 1996	Wigston, LE18	landarroofing.co.uk
Leicester Traditional Roofing	Roofer	Wigston, LE18	hamuch.com
Continental Motors	Family garage, since 1987	Leicester	continentalmotors.co.uk
The Motor Company	Family garage	Golf Course Lane, LE3	motorcompanyleicester.co.uk
Wyvern Garage	Family garage	Leicester	wyverngarageleicester.co.uk
A1 Car Repairs Leicester	Family garage, since 1989	Leicester	a1carrepairsleicester.co.uk
Kato's Auto Centre	Garage	Leicester	katos-car-service.co.uk
Knighton Dental Practice	Dentist	Knighton	knightondental.co.uk
Winchester Avenue Dental Surgery	Dentist, NHS and private	Leicester	winchesteravenuedentalsurgery.co.uk
Eagle Barber	Barber	38 Narborough Rd, LE3	fresha.com
DSY Barbers	Barber	280 Narborough Rd, LE3	fresha.com
Meraki Hair Salon	Hair salon	Queens Road, Clarendon Park	DLUXE

Business	Type	Area	Source
KL A Barbers	Unisex barber	Montague Road, Clarendon Park	DLUXE
Fingerprints Delicafe	Cafe	65 Queens Road	DLUXE
Sharmilee	Restaurant and sweet shop	71-73 Belgrave Road	Great Food Club
Bobby's	Vegetarian restaurant, since 1976	154-156 Belgrave Road	Great Food Club
Ambica's	Sweets and street food, since 1987	Belgrave Road	Great Food Club

Best walk-in routes for your first afternoons: Narborough Road (dozens of barbers, cafes and takeaways within a 20-minute walk), Queens Road in Clarendon Park (salons and cafes with owners on site), and the Golden Mile on Belgrave Road (high review volume restaurants and sweet shops, go 2pm to 4pm before the evening rush). Garages and roofers get a phone call, not a walk-in.

The free audit (your hook)

The audit gets you the meeting. It's one page, takes you 15 minutes per business, and shows the owner something about their own business they've never looked at. Make 10 of them before you contact anyone.

What goes on the page (build it once in Canva, then swap the details):

1. Their name and logo at the top, and a screenshot of their Google listing.
2. Three numbers: star rating, total reviews, and "X of your last 10 reviews have no reply."
3. One screenshot of an unanswered review, ideally a negative one sitting there with no response.
4. Under it, the reply you would have written (use the prompt in the Delivering section). This is the moment that sells it.
5. A short list of 3 fixes: "No posts since March," "Sunday hours missing," "No photos added in 14 months."

6. One line at the bottom: "I can fix all of this for you. First month free. [Your name, phone]."

Prompt to draft the audit text fast (paste their details in):

You're helping me write a short, friendly Google Business Profile audit for a local business owner. Business: [name], [niche], [town]. Rating: [x.x] from [n] reviews. Unanswered reviews in the last 10: [n]. Last Google post: [date or never]. Problems I noticed: [list]. Write: (1) a 2-sentence summary of what's costing them customers, in plain language, no jargon, no mention of AI; (2) the 3 most important fixes as short lines; (3) a professional owner reply to this unanswered review: "[paste review]".

Save each audit as a PDF named "[Business Name] Google Profile Check.pdf". Print 5 for walk-ins.

Outreach scripts

Walk-ins convert best by far, so do them first. Go between 2pm and 4pm on a Tuesday to Thursday, when restaurants are quiet and offices are past the lunch rush. Expect roughly 1 interested owner per 8 to 10 walk-ins. Phone and email are backup.

Being 20 is an advantage

Some owners will clock your age in the first five seconds. Don't hide it and don't apologise for it. Owners in their 40s and 50s already assume younger people understand Google and phones better than they do, so lean into that. "I'm Tyler, I'm 20, I'm from Leicester, and this is the stuff I'm good at" lands well, especially with family-run shops where the owner's own kids probably nag them about their Google page. What gets you dismissed is looking unprepared. The printed audit with their business name on it does the heavy lifting: it proves you've done the work before you've asked for anything. Dress smart casual (clean trainers are fine, no hoodie), keep eye contact, and keep it short.

Walk-in (salons, restaurants, auto shops, dental front desks)

"Hi, is the owner or manager around? ... Hi, I'm Tyler, I'm from Leicester. I help local businesses round here with their Google reviews. I looked at yours and made you this, it's free. You've got [47] reviews and a 4.4, which is great, but 7 of your last 10 have no reply, including this 2-star one from August. People read those before they call. I wrote the reply you could post, it's right there. If you want, I'll handle all of it for the next month for free, and you only keep me on if you see a difference. Can I grab 10 minutes with you this week?"

If the owner isn't in: leave the printed audit in an envelope with their name on it, and write "For [owner name], made this for you, [your name, phone]" on the front. Call two days later.

Phone (contractors, who are never at the shop)

"Hi, is this [owner]? I'm Tyler, I'm based in Leicester. Quick one, I was looking at [business] on Google and noticed a few reviews sitting there without replies, including a 1-star from a couple of months back. I put together a one-page check of your listing, free. Can I text it to you?"

If yes, text the PDF right away with: "Here's the check I mentioned. The reply I'd post to that 1-star is on there. Happy to handle all of it free for a month. Tyler"

Email (dentists, med spas, anyone with a website contact address)

Subject: Your Google reviews, [Business Name]

Hi [first name],

I'm Tyler, I'm based in Leicester. I was looking at [Business Name] on Google. You've got a strong 4.5 rating, but 6 of your last 10 reviews haven't had a reply, and one from a frustrated patient in September is still sitting at the top.

I put together a free one-page check of your listing (attached), including the reply I'd post to that review.

I'm taking on two local businesses this month for a free 30-day trial. Want one of the spots?

[Name] [Phone]

Follow-up (2 to 3 days later, every time)

"Hey [name], just checking you saw the Google check I dropped off. Still have one free spot this month if you want it. Either way, that reply to the 2-star is yours to use."

Most of your yeses will come from the follow-up, not the first touch. People skip it because it feels pushy. It isn't. Owners are busy and forget.

Volume target for days 3 to 10: 40 walk-ins, 30 calls, 30 emails. That should land you 6 to 10 conversations and 2 to 4 yeses.

Delivering the work

Once a client says yes, the setup takes about 2 hours, and then each client takes 30 to 60 minutes a week. With 10 clients that's a part-time job paying £1,300 to £2,000 a month.

Onboarding call (20 minutes)

Ask these and save the answers in a note per client. They become the "brand voice" you paste into every prompt:

1. How do you want to sign replies? ("Dr. Patel and the team," "Mike, Owner")
2. What makes you different? Two or three real things.
3. Anything you never want said? (No discounts offered, no admitting fault, no medical details.)
4. Who handles angry customers, and what's their phone number or email?
5. Approve negative replies before posting, or trust me? (Start with approval on 1 to 3 star reviews for the first month.)

Then get Manager access (see Tools and setup).

Master reply prompt

Save this once per client, with their details filled in:

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You write Google review replies for [Business Name], a [niche] in [town].  
Sign off as "[sign-off]". Voice: warm, local, plain English, like the owner  
wrote it on their phone. Rules: 2 to 4 sentences. Use the reviewer's first  
name. Mention one specific detail from their review. Mention the service or  
dish naturally if it fits (helps local search). Never use the phrases "we  
value your feedback" or "we apologize for any inconvenience." Never offer  
refunds or discounts. Never confirm someone was a patient or share private  
details. For 1 to 3 stars: acknowledge, don't argue, take it offline with  
[contact]. Write one reply per review below.
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[paste reviews]
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Always read every reply before posting. AI occasionally invents a detail, and one weird reply on a public profile costs you the client.

Example replies

A 5-star review for a roofer: "Jake and his crew replaced our roof in one day and cleaned up every nail. Highly recommend."

Thanks so much, Linda! Jake will be happy to hear the cleanup got noticed; he's strict about the magnet sweep at the end of every job. Enjoy the new roof, and give us a shout if you ever need anything. Mike, Owner

A 2-star review for a restaurant: "Food was good but we waited 45 minutes for our mains on a Saturday."

Hi Sam, thanks for being honest about this. A 45-minute wait isn't what we want for anyone, even on a busy Saturday, and we've been adding a cook on weekend nights to fix exactly that. Glad you enjoyed the food. If you give us another try, ask for me and I'll look after you. Maria, Owner

A 1-star for a dental office: "Rude receptionist, they charged me for something I was told was covered."

Hi Tom, I'm sorry this visit left you frustrated. Billing confusion is stressful and we want to get it right. Could you call our office manager Jen directly at 0116 123 4567 so she can go through it with you personally? The team at Bright Smile Dental

Note the dental reply never confirms Tom is a patient. UK dentists have patient confidentiality duties under UK GDPR and GDC guidance, so keep these general.

A star-only review with no text:

Thank you for the 5 stars, Priya! We really appreciate you taking the time. See you next time. The team at Fade Lab

Weekly Google post (Growth tier)

One post a week with a real photo from the client (ask them to text you 4 photos a month: a job, the team, a dish, the shop). Prompt:

Write a Google Business Profile post for [Business Name], a [niche] in [town]. Topic: [this week's photo/news, e.g. finished a slate roof in Oadby]. 60 to 120 words. Friendly, specific, local. Mention [town] once and the service once. End with a clear action: call [phone] or book at [link]. No hashtags, no emojis.

Post ideas that work every month: a finished job, a team member intro, a seasonal tip ("3 signs your boiler needs a service before winter"), an answer to a question customers always ask, and a recent 5-star review turned into a post.

One-time profile fixes (first week of each client)

- ☐ Hours correct, including holiday hours
- ☐ Every service or menu category listed, with a short description
- ☐ 10+ recent photos uploaded (exterior, interior, team, work)
- ☐ Business description rewritten (750 characters, mentions town and main services)
- ☐ Q&A: add 5 common questions with answers
- ☐ Review link created (Profile, "Ask for reviews") and turned into a QR code on a Canva counter card
- ☐ Clear out the old unanswered backlog (the £79 catch-up)

Monthly report (5 minutes per client)

Screenshot the Performance tab in their profile (calls, direction requests, website clicks) and send a short text or email: "October: replied to 14 reviews, posted 4 updates, you got 9 new reviews (up from 4 in September), calls from Google up 18%." This text is what keeps them paying. Never skip it.

Your 14-day plan

About 3 to 4 hours a day. Week 1 is setup and outreach. Week 2 is closing and delivering. Tick these off as you go.

Week 1

Day 1: setup

- ☐ Pick your business name and create the Gmail
- ☐ Set up the Prospects and Clients sheet
- ☐ Order business cards (next-day print at a local shop or Vistaprint)
- ☐ Save the master reply prompt and audit prompt in a notes file

Day 2: build the list

- ☐ Pick 2 niches to start (recommended for Leicester: independent garages by phone, and Narborough Road and Queens Road barbers and salons on foot)
- ☐ Find 50 prospects on Google Maps and log them
- ☐ Star the 15 with the most unanswered reviews

Day 3: audits

- ☐ Build the audit template in Canva
- ☐ Make audits for your top 10 prospects

- ☐ Print the 5 walk-in ones

Day 4: first outreach

- ☐ 10 walk-ins (afternoon)
- ☐ 10 phone calls to contractors (7 to 8am or 4 to 5pm, when they're not on a roof)
- ☐ Log every result in the sheet

Day 5: outreach

- ☐ 10 walk-ins
- ☐ Send 15 audit emails
- ☐ Make 5 more audits

Days 6 and 7: weekend

- ☐ Follow up with everyone from days 4 and 5 (text or call)
- ☐ Set up the Carrd one-page site with your offer and a testimonial spot
- ☐ Practise the walk-in script out loud 10 times. Seriously, it shows.

Week 2

Day 8: outreach and first meetings

- ☐ 10 walk-ins, 10 calls
- ☐ Book any interested owners for a 10-minute sit-down

Day 9: close

- ☐ Meetings: show the audit, offer the free month, get Manager access before you leave
- ☐ Send 15 more audit emails

Day 10: deliver pilot 1

- ☐ Onboarding questions answered and saved
- ☐ Clear the review backlog and fix the profile checklist
- ☐ First weekly post up
- ☐ Send the owner a screenshot: "Done. All 23 reviews answered." That message alone gets referrals.

Day 11: outreach and pilot 2

- ☐ Onboard pilot 2 the same way
- ☐ Second round of follow-ups to everyone who went quiet

Day 12: paid conversions

- ☐ Pitch your next 3 prospects at the paid price, not free. You now have a real example to show.
- ☐ Use your pilot's before and after screenshots in every conversation

Days 13 and 14: systemise

- ☐ Set a weekly routine: Monday replies, Wednesday posts, Friday outreach
- ☐ Ask both pilots: "Who else do you know who'd want this?" Owners know other owners.
- ☐ Decide on a payment setup (GoCardless direct debit or a Stripe payment link, monthly recurring) and register as a sole trader with HMRC

Realistic outcome by day 14: 2 pilots running, 1 or 2 paid clients signed or close, and a list of warm leads. The pilots convert to £129 to £199 a month in week 5. If you're at zero yeses after 100 contacts, the problem is the script or the niche, so switch niche before you change anything else.

Objections and mistakes to avoid

They say	You say
"I can do that myself."	"You can. You just haven't for 6 months, because you're running a business. That's the whole job I take off you."
"Does replying even matter?"	"Google says businesses that reply look more trustworthy, and customers read the replies to bad reviews more than the review itself. That 2-star with no answer is the first thing people see."
"Is this AI? I don't want robot replies."	"I write every reply in your voice and read every one before it goes up. You can approve the negative ones first."
"I've been burned by marketing agencies."	"No contract, cancel by text. And the first month's free, so you see it working before you pay anything."
"Too expensive."	"One extra customer a month covers it. For a roofer, that's one job out of the year." Then offer Starter instead of Growth.
"Let me think about it."	"Totally. Can I do the backlog of replies for free this week so you can see what they look like? No strings."

Mistakes that kill this business early:

- Asking for Owner access. Always Manager. Asking for Owner scares people and they'd be right to say no.
- Posting AI replies without reading them. One reply that thanks someone for a "wonderful stay" at a plumbing company and you're done.
- Writing fake reviews or "review gating" (only asking happy customers to review). Both break Google's rules and can get the profile suspended.
- Spending week 1 on a logo and website. Nobody cares. Spend it walking into businesses.
- Stopping after one round of outreach. The follow-up is where the yeses come from.
- Giving away more than 2 free pilots. After that, everyone pays.

Your first move tomorrow: open the Leicester starter list on Google Maps, find the 5 with the most unanswered reviews, and make their audits.